

Chapter 93_2 - Approaching

Ning Fuyi let out a long sigh. She swept her hair behind her ear, then got up and returned to the room, pulling out a glazed cup from her Mindful Pearl¹ and placing it on the table.

"I've been flattered and appeased by people for thirty years, never thought I'd hit a snag with you." Ning Fuyi murmured softly, poking the head of the gardenia flower several times to vent her frustration.

The little flower didn't know why it was being poked and was quite displeased. All the leaves around it surged forward, desperately pushing Ning Fuyi's hand away.

Ning Fuyi was amused by its resistance. Her red lips curved slightly, and she softened her touch, turning the poking into gentle caressing.

The little flower's displeasure came and went quickly. Before long, it began nuzzling her palm as usual, happily releasing its rich creamy fragrance.

"You're still cuter as a flower, without so many shackles and constraints, able to do as you please." Ning Fuyi said, her gaze drifting past the flower branches, becoming distant.

"The you now is like a cactus, covered in thorns all over. Touch you once and get pricked. You are indeed such a person, standing on the clouds—others may watch you in your wretched state, but they're not allowed to pity you."

"Tell me, what should I do? Truly keep my distance and watch from afar?"

"But I've already found you, how can I do that?" Ning Fuyi rested her cheek against her arm, extremely troubled.

If the person beside her now wasn't Su Mo but Chu Qingqiu, how would she approach her?

No, wait—she had never actively approached Chu Qingqiu. It seemed that every time she was injured or in danger, Chu Qingqiu would appear.

Thinking of this, Ning Fuyi's eyes suddenly lit up like starlight. She quickly put the gardenia flower back into her Mindful Pearl and hurried to the kitchen, pretending to prepare food for herself.

Ning Fuyi didn't need to cook at Cloud Ascension Mountain Gate. In her previous life after becoming a demon, she didn't need to eat. In this life, she had already achieved fasting², so she knew absolutely nothing about culinary arts.

Therefore, she didn't need to act—before long, she had made a complete mess of the kitchen, even getting several streaks of soot on her face. Just as she crouched on the ground trying to blow the fire in the stove to life, Su Mo, who had been watching for some time, finally couldn't bear it anymore. She opened the door and stood behind her.

Ning Fuyi looked up from her half-crouched position, flashing a bright smile with all her white teeth showing.

Su Mo's eyes flashed with a hint of helplessness, then she avoided Ning Fuyi's gaze and gestured for her to move aside.

Ning Fuyi was delighted that this trick worked and immediately turned around and stood up, hands behind her back, standing obediently.

Su Mo was much faster than her. She skillfully picked up a fan to fan the flames, then re-cut the chicken that Ning Fuyi had butchered into pieces, tossing it into the pot with scallions and garlic to stew. She also took out the white flour Ning Fuyi had bought, kneaded it into dough, and shaped it into pieces that she stuck around the edge of the iron pot.

The series of actions left Ning Fuyi dazzled. After about half an hour, both dishes and flatbread were on the table, and the mouth-watering aroma rushed into her nostrils. Even Ning Fuyi, who had been fasting for many years, felt her mouth water.

Su Mo turned to leave, but Ning Fuyi instinctively reached out to grab her sleeve. However, she quickly noticed the woman's fear and trembling, and hurriedly put her hands behind her back.

She said softly, "Please stay and eat with me. Living here already weighs on my conscience, and now I've troubled you to help me. If you just leave like this, I'm afraid I won't be able to sleep tonight."

Ning Fuyi spoke earnestly, not daring to look at Su Mo as she spoke, her whole demeanor appearing clumsy and gentle, which diminished her demonic aura.

Su Mo looked at her for a while, then lowered her eyes and sat down, picking up chopsticks.

Seeing that her scheme was working, Ning Fuyi was overjoyed inside, though she didn't show it. Instead, she went to get another set of bowl and chopsticks, then sat down gracefully.

The path to getting close to Su Mo had finally made some progress, although this progress was indeed quite difficult.

The following day repeated everything from this day. Ning Fuyi got up before the rooster crowed to fetch water. After breakfast, Su Mo shouldered her basket and continued up the mountain to gather herbs. Ning Fuyi secretly followed her up the mountain, then secretly returned to the house to wait for her.

Thirty years passed like the snap of a finger, and two days went by even faster. Before Ning Fuyi had accomplished anything, the morning of the third day had already arrived. Su Mo placed the last bowl of medicinal soup in her hands and gestured: "Two days have passed. Miss may leave now."

She spoke very flatly, without a hint of reluctance. Ning Fuyi couldn't bring herself to be thick-skinned, so she could only gulp down the medicinal soup and thank her quietly.

"I've already filled the water tank for you today, so you don't need to fetch water. I've also washed the bowls and chopsticks, tidied the room, and changed to new bedding. You can move back in and don't need to fear anything." The woman spoke very carefully, as if afraid of frightening her again. Su Mo clenched her hands in her sleeves and nodded.

Initially, she felt this woman had too much killing intent about her, with sharp features that didn't make her seem like a good person, so she was even more fearful and guarded than usual. However, after these two days together, she discovered that the woman was gentle and courteous, meticulous and thoughtful.

Usually, those people would call her "Ugly" and say she was a sinister thing with a strange and eerie nature. Therefore, except for a few individuals, most people either avoided her like the plague or mocked and ridiculed her.

However, this woman had never treated her as a monster from beginning to end. Her behavior was polite and respectful throughout.

But this only proved she was a good person. If she really stayed as suggested, once she learned just how strange she truly was, she would definitely be frightened.

It was better to live alone. Why frighten others?

Thinking this, she turned aside and indifferently raised her hand, gesturing for her to leave.

Ning Fuyi could only consider this trip a temporary failure. She smiled at her, turned around, and left the small courtyard, walking back to town along the grassy ground.

After Ning Fuyi had gone far, Su Mo felt a chill around her. She hugged herself and lowered her head, suppressing the fear in her heart. Today, she had to go to that place again.

She turned around, shouldered the heavy basket, and stepped out the door.

Footnotes:

¹ **Mindful Pearl (一念珠)** - A storage artifact in cultivation novels, similar to a spatial ring, that can hold items in a separate dimensional space.

² **Fasting (辟谷)** - A cultivation state where practitioners no longer need to consume regular food for sustenance, instead drawing energy from spiritual qi.